

locating, opening and using three different applications to dim lights, change the temperature and check if your alarm is working fine, all you need to do is open your smart hub's application which acts as the command centre for everything you want to control.

So, let's look at the various smart hubs available in the market, their pros and cons, and what the future holds for this tech.

But before that, there are a couple of things you need to know

Things to know before buying a smart hub

With so many different companies and devices in the market, how do you make sure that the hub you are buying will work with them all? All these devices use a variety of different technologies and standards. There are several Wi-Fi and Bluetooth compatible thermostats and smart locks, but most of the smart lights and alarm sensors don't use these communication technologies and instead opt for other relatively unknown standards like ZigBee and Z-Wave. Many smart home devices still don't use Wi-Fi even though it has a high bandwidth and hence can carry heavy data, because it increases their power consumption and will need to be connected to a dedicated source of power throughout. Also, the Wi-Fi chips used are expensive and bring up the cost of these already 'not-so-cheap' smart devices.

The new Bluetooth standard, Bluetooth LE (Low Energy) doesn't hog as much power as its predecessors and provides a secure connection and good bandwidth.



A number of smart devices in the market right now are using Z-wave and ZigBee